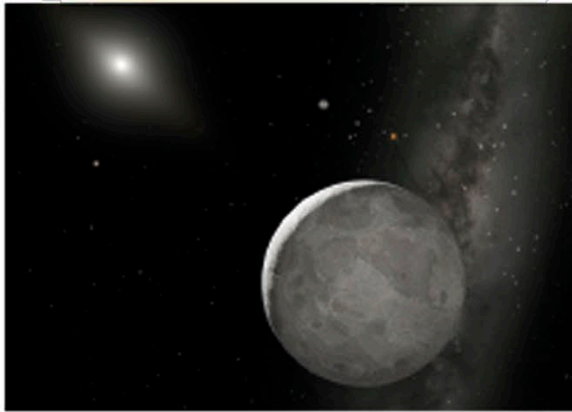


2005 ▶ 2010



Artist's impression of Eris

2005

Eris discovered

American astronomers discovered Eris, a rocky body that orbits the Sun beyond Neptune and which was thought to be larger than Pluto. The following year, the International Astronomical Union (IAU) changed Pluto to the status of dwarf planet—a group that includes Eris as well as the asteroid Ceres.

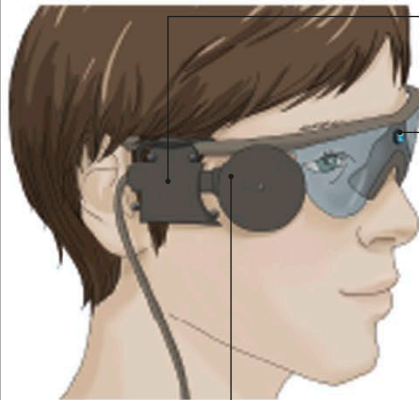


Launched in 2006, Blu-ray optical discs could hold up to 10 times the amount of data as a regular DVD.

2006

First trials of Argus II prosthetic eye

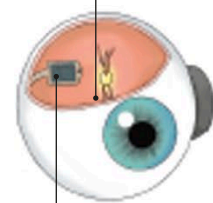
The prosthetic, or artificial, eye called Argus II features a camera that captures images, which are relayed as signals to tiny electrodes implanted in the retina (light-sensitive layer) at the back of a person's impaired eye. There, the signals stimulate the retinal cells to send signals from the eye down the optic nerve to the brain, enabling sight.



2. Video processor unit (VPU) converts visual data into electrical impulses.

1. Tiny video camera captures the view ahead.

Retina



3. Radio antenna sends impulses from the VPU to an implant inside the eye.

4. Electrode implant receives impulses and stimulates retinal cells.



2005

2005

First partial face transplant

French surgeon Dr. Bernard Devauchelle and his team performed the first partial face transplant in Amiens, France, on Isabelle Dinoire, who was attacked and badly disfigured by her dog. The surgical team replaced much of her nose, mouth, and cheeks in a successful and ground-breaking operation.

Cross-section of Airbus 380

Aircraft has a wingspan of 261.6 ft (79.8 m).

2007

Airbus A380-800

The first Airbus A380-800—the world's biggest airliner—was delivered to Singapore Airlines. The aircraft features two passenger decks that can carry up to 853 passengers in all-economy seating, and has a maximum take-off weight of 634 tons (575 metric tons).

Approximately 25 percent of the aircraft's structure is made from carbon-fiber-reinforced plastic.

First-class seats recline into beds.

21-ft- (6.5-m-) wide main deck can hold rows of up to ten economy seats.

Four large turbofan engines give a maximum range of 9,600 miles (15,400 km).